SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

EXPLORING TEACHERS' IMPLEMENTATION OF THE MATATAG ENGLISH CURRICULUM GUIDE

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Teacher Education

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF SECONDARY EDUCATION MAJOR IN ENGLISH

By

JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
RUCMINIE E. GESTA
MARIA FE L. BERMAS
RALPH C. BERTUMEN

ADVISER: KENNETH IAN B. BARRERA, PhD.

OCTOBER 2025

TABLE OF CONTENTS

		Pages
TITLE PAGE		i
CERTIFICATE OF PANEL APPROVAL		ii
ABSTRACT		iii
DEDICATION		iv
ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS		v
TABLE OF CONTENTS		vi
LIST OF TABLES		viii
LIST OF FIGURES		x
CHAPTER		
1	**THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE**	1
	1.1 Background of the study	1
	1.2 Review of Related Literature	4
	1.3 Theoretical Framework	22
	1.4 Schematic Diagram	26
	1.5 Objectives of the Study	26
	1.6 Scope and Limitations	27
	1.7 Definition of Terms	27
2	**RESEARCH METHODOLOGY**	29
	2.1 Research Design	29
	2.2 Research Materials and Methods	31
	2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample	31
	2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan	33
	2.5 Research Ethical Standards	36
3	**RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS**	
	3.1 Presentation and Analysis of Data	
	3.2 Proposed Intervention/ Output	
4	**SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS**	
	4.1 Summary	
	4.2 Conclusion	
	4.3 Recommendations	
REFERENCES		
CURRICULUM VITAE		
APPENDICES		
CERTIFICATE OF TECHNOLOGY BASED ASSESSMENT		
PUBLISHABLE JOURNAL		

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
College of Teacher Education

CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis entitled **"EXPLORING TEACHERS' IMPLEMENTATION OF THE MATATAG ENGLISH CURRICULUM GUIDE"** presented and submitted by JOECYL T. MONTALBAN, RUCMINIE U. GESTA, MARIA FE L. BERMAS, RALPH C. BERTUMEN in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of BSED ENGLISH is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

KENNETH IAN B. BARRERA, PHD
Adviser

RICKY C. DESTACAMENTO, RGC, MA
Member

DIVINA S. COMPENDIO, MAED- ELT
Member

MELISA C. MALOLOY-ON, EdD-EM
Member

BEVERLY D. JAMINAL, EdD-ISRM
Chairperson

ACCEPTED as partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of BSED ENGLISH

APPROVED by the tribunal at the Oral Examination with the grade of _____.

KENNETH IAN B. BARRERA, PHD
Adviser

RICKY C. DESTACAMENTO, RGC, MA
Member

DIVINA S. COMPENDIO, MAED- ELT
Member

MELISA C. MALOLOY-ON, EdD-EM
Member

BEVERLY D. JAMINAL, EdD-ISRM
Chairperson

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
Nasipit, Agusan del Norte

College of Teacher Education
ABSTRACT

TITLE:	**"EXPLORING TEACHERS' IMPLEMENTATION OF THE MATATAG ENGLISH CURRICULUM GUIDE**
AUTHOR:	JOECYL T. MONTALBAN, RUCMINIE U. GESTA, MARIA FE L. BERMAS, RALPH C. BERTUMEN
DEGREE:	BSED-ENGLISH
ADVISER:	KENNETH IAN B. BARRERA, PhD.
PLACE OF PUBLICATION:	SMCC Nasipit, Agusan del Norte
DATE	XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
PAGES	XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

(RESEARCH DESIGN)

I. OBJECTIVES

XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

II. METHODOLOGY

XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

III. FINDINGS

XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

KEYWORDS: XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

DEDICATION

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

LIST OF TABLES

Table	Pages
1	
2	
3	

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Curriculum reform is now a key global strategy for improving education systems. Countries are realigning standards to meet the needs of 21st-century skills such as literacy, critical thinking, and global competence (Marinette and Hui, 2020; Pak et al., 2020). Still, reform in the Philippine often faces issues such as curriculum overload, poor teacher preparation, and misaligned assessments. The K to 12 curriculum aimed to expand basic education and support readiness for college and careers. However, new issues have emerged: learning poverty, excessive content, and limited teacher training (Abragan et al., 2022). The Department of Education (DepEd) responded by launching the MATATAG Curriculum through DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024. This framework will start in the 2024–2025 school year. It focuses on foundational learning and lifelong skills. It also aims to simplify language education to enhance communication, critical thinking, and cultural relevance (Estrellado, 2023). Early reports show a gap between curriculum goals and students' readiness. Grade 7 English students still struggle with basic literacy, bringing ongoing challenges for teachers.

Internationally, competency-based or autonomous curriculum models have benefits and challenges. Indonesia's Merdeka curriculum pushes for student-centered learning and English taught in context. This approach underscores the need for ongoing teacher development and improved workload management (Hanum and Dalimunte 2025; Husnaini, 2025). Other countries—Kazakhstan, Ghana, Zimbabwe, and Pakistan—face problems too. They struggle with teacher stress, unclear roles, and little help during policy shifts (Husnaini, 2025; Jadoon et al., 2020; Ngwenya 2020; Takyi et al., 2025).

According to Aslam et al., (2024) and Pak et al., (2020), “maturity gap” is one of the major issue wherein reforms are introduced faster than teachers and educational systems can adapt, resulting in incomplete classroom implementation. Curriculum reforms are meant to modernize, yet they often fail to link policies to real classroom conditions. The most obvious in English teaching is that global aims must match local needs. In the Philippines, the K to 12 reform sought to modernize education and align it with global standards. However, unclear curriculum, mismatched assessments, and unprepared English teachers slowed progress (Bernardo, 2022). Teachers said they lacked materials, had heavy workloads, and received weak training (Palestina et al., 2020). The COVID-19 pandemic made things worse by interrupting teaching and showing gaps in equality. More students needed extra help (Aranda 2022; Obja-an 2024).

The MATATAG Curriculum aims to fix these issues. It reduces excess content, boosts cultural relevance, and strengthens basics (Gaudicos et al,. 2024; Kilag et al., 2024). Early feedback indicates teacher readiness varies, with opinions mixed. Some teachers feel more confident after training. According to Bejasa (2025), Gumilao and Langam (2025), Monton and Ducot (2025), teachers still face difficulties in interpreting competencies, managing workloads, an addressing diverse learners’ needs. Similarly, Omega (2025) and Toledo (2025) highlight that overcoming these challenges requires strong school leadership, adequate resources, and supportive systems to ensure effective curriculum implementation.

This study looks at the urgent need to understand how the MATATAG Curriculum is used in Philippine secondary English classes. The curriculum focuses on clarity, less crowded content, and skills-based learning. However, global and local reports show that classroom gaps remain. Grade 7 English students, transitioning from elementary to high school, still struggle with literacy and language. Teachers must bridge these gaps despite limited training, high workloads, and few

resources. This gap highlights the gap between policy ideas and classroom reality. Research should focus on what teachers experience, since they put curriculum changes into practice.

The goal of this study are therefore is to identify the challenges encountered by Grade 7 English Teachers in implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide; to describe how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide; to identify their best practices in addressing students' diverse needs; to develop a transition program that supports effective classroom implementation. This research aims to collect context-specific insights that are timely to support institutional-level support systems, promote teacher professional growth, and inform policy refinement through the wider discourse on curriculum changes.

The significance of this study reaches different groups in the Philippine education system, especially those involved in the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide. For teachers, the results give practical guidance on how to apply the curriculum effectively through lesson planning, classroom teaching, and assessment. These insights can help teachers solve teaching challenges, improve their teaching skills, and use more responsive methods in English instruction. For school administrators, the study offers useful guidance for creating targeted teacher training programs, providing appropriate resources, and improving supervision to support teachers and ensure the curriculum is well implemented. For the Department of Education, the results can serve as evidence to guide curriculum updates, improve training programs, and strengthen the implementation process to meet the goals of the MATATAG reform.

Although the study is limited to selected schools, its findings help explain how teachers turn curriculum policy into real classroom practice. In the end, the main beneficiaries are the students, whose English learning will help them build literacy, critical thinking, and communication skills—important foundations for lifelong and academic success.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

The Philippine education system undergoes major changes, and the transition from the K–12 program to the MATATAG Curriculum marks an important shift toward a simpler, more student-centered approach. Based on DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024. The MATATAG curriculum aims to reduce the number of learning competencies, strengthen basic literacy and numeracy, and connect teaching practices with Filipino values and global standards.

The curriculum began its implementation in the 2024–2025 school year, starting with Grades 1, 4, and 7 to ensure a smooth, planned rollout. This review looks closely at the early stages of MATATAG, focusing on Grade 7 English teachers, who play a key role in turning policy into actual classroom practice. By examining their teaching challenges, classroom strategies, and ways of adjusting to change, the study aims to show how teachers manage the gap between what the curriculum expects and what happens in real classrooms. In the end, it highlights the important role teachers play in shaping the success of education reform during its early stage.

Curriculum reforms in the Philippine education system

The history of curriculum reform in the Philippines shows a pattern of ambitious ideas, uneven implementation, and frequent changes. Each reform from the K–12 program to the current MATATAG Curriculum reflects the country's continuing efforts to improve education and address long-standing issues in teacher training, school leadership, and student performance. The K to 12 reform, seen as a major shift, was weakened by structural problems and poor execution (Malbas et al., 2023). According to Barrot (2023), the goal of preparing "future-ready" learners was hindered by excessive content and insufficient teacher training. These problems led to the need for a corrective reform.

The MATATAG Curriculum was introduced through DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024. It aims to simplify learning goals, eliminate redundant content, and align learning outcomes with the key

skills needed for lifelong learning. Estrellado (2023) pointed to decongestion as a major improvement in MATATAG, highlighting its goal to reduce content overload, focus teaching on essential skills, and give teachers more time to help students improve in reading and communication.

Diquito (2024) noted early improvements in subject clarity, especially in science, where clearer learning goals helped teachers focus better and align lessons with classroom tests. Similarly, Kilag et al., (2024) stated that MATATAG's focus on student-centered, context-based content is a major improvement over the K–12 model, making lessons more relevant and adaptable to classroom needs. However, curriculum reforms in the Philippines are often influenced by political changes rather than regular, evidence-based reviews. The long-term success of MATATAG will likely depend on having systems for ongoing evaluation, strong teacher training, and stable policies across leadership changes.

Current research on curriculum reform in the Philippines is broad but varies in depth and quality. For example, Aguas (2020) said that the success of reform depends mostly on how teachers and school leaders understand and apply policy goals in their schools. Likewise, Nengasca (2025) stressed that successful implementation requires clear guidance, ongoing support, and alignment between policy goals and classroom practice. Together, these studies show that while teachers try to support reform, gaps in training and coordination across schools make consistent implementation difficult.

At the system level, studies by Barrot (2019) and Galaura and Simpal (2025) offer useful insights, but their findings are mostly descriptive. (Barrot, 2019) found ongoing gaps in how subjects are sequenced, how assessments align with teaching, and how lessons connect. Galaura and Simpal (2025) linked poor teaching quality to limited resources and heavy teacher workloads.

However, both studies used cross-sectional data, which limits their ability to measure long-term effects on student learning.

This research trend highlights the need for continuous, evidence-based monitoring to evaluate reforms like MATATAG against actual student progress. However, national and regional tests such as PISA (2018) and SEA-PLM show that the Philippines still performs poorly in reading and math. It points to a gap between the goals of reform and real learning results. Even after programs like K–12 and MATATAG, students' reading and writing scores remain among the lowest globally, especially in Grade 7 English. These findings show the lack of long-term, evidence-based systems that connect curriculum changes to real improvements in literacy. As a result, policymakers often rely on broad national data instead of classroom-level outcomes.

Across Southeast Asia, the MATATAG Curriculum aligns with regional trends toward competency-based, flexible learning. Indonesia's Merdeka Curriculum supports teacher independence, context-based teaching, and ongoing professional development to improve literacy and communication (Indraprasta and Pawiro, 2023). Vietnam used a step-by-step reform process, supported by continuous teacher development, to prepare schools for full implementation. Singapore uses regular curriculum reviews that include assessment data to keep policy and classroom practice aligned. These examples show that successful curriculum reform depends on stable government, steady funding, and organized systems for monitoring.

In conclusion, the MATATAG Curriculum is a response to the problems of the K to 12 program. It focuses on reducing content, making learning more relevant, and giving teachers more control. However, ongoing issues in teacher training, classroom monitoring, and policy stability still put its success at risk. The lack of long-term data and a clear evaluation system makes it hard to know whether MATATAG is improving literacy, especially in English. To achieve real results, reform must be grounded in evidence, supported by robust teacher development, and backed by

consistent policies. In the end, Grade 7 English teachers—who act as the main link between policy and classroom practice—will play a key role in showing whether MATATAG teaching goals lead to real progress in student learning and communication skills.

Curriculum Guide

The Curriculum Guide is a document that puts the DepEd reform agenda into action in the classroom. It provides teachers with clear content, performance, and learning competencies for each subject and grade level (DepEd, 2024). The guide suggests dividing the curriculum into quarters and includes example tasks to make the previous K to 12 curriculum less cluttered. It also says that communicative competence, critical thinking, and cultural relevance should be the main learning goals.

Recent qualitative studies highlight that, while the MATATAG guide enhances clarity and focus, its efficacy depends on teachers' interpretations and adaptations in real classrooms. According to Malinao and Miano (2025), educators actively contextualize and enhance the guide's competencies to accommodate learner diversity and address gaps. They often reorganize content and create new activities to ensure lessons stay relevant and engaging. Berecio et al., (2025) stated that differentiated instruction guided by the curriculum needed to reach various students. However, problems remain, such as a lack of training and materials.

According to Bejasa (2025) and Torrefiel et al., (2025), a phenomenological research design was used to examine how teachers' experiences with the curriculum guide are shaped by its structural strengths and weaknesses. Transparent learning progressions are a benefit. Heightened workload and the need for ongoing professional development are challenges. Belga et al., (2025) support these findings. They emphasize that the guide's success depends on ongoing institutional support and on teacher autonomy in adapting standards to local contexts.

In conclusion, the curriculum guide aims to simplify and streamline the instruction. However, teachers' ability to facilitate, adapt, and innovate within the provided framework will ultimately decide its impact. This dynamic underscore the need for ongoing support, resources, and training to ensure reforms deliver real gains in student learning.

MATATAG English Curriculum

The MATATAG English Curriculum was intended to address the weaknesses of the old K-12 system by prioritizing more straightforward, powerful core literacies. As stated by Gaudicos et al., (2024) and Kilag et al., (2024), MATATAG is designed to provide a practical, learner-focused framework that incorporates Philippine values with global standards. According to Alvarado (2023), English teaching focuses on communicative competence, critical thinking, and contextual language, all of which are vital skills for 21st-century learners. Origenes (2025) noted that Grade 7 is an essential developmental phase for improving reading, writing, and oral skills, which aligns with the objective of MATATAG to seal the learning gaps at the foundational stage. It is on these principles that MATATAG accepts teachers as key agents of change who translate curriculum designs into classroom practice.

Empirical studies indicate that there are persistent discrepancies between the objectives of reform and classroom practices. Abaiz et al., (2024) and Elardo (2025) discovered that improvisation is one of the strategies many English teachers apply because they lack sufficient preparation time and resources. According to Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025), although teachers are eager to adopt communicative pedagogy, excessive workload and unclear assessment criteria prevent them from adhering to the entire curriculum. This fact demonstrates that commitment is not enough to address systemic problems in institutional support and professional growth.

Initial enthusiasm declined over time. Lagbao (2024) noted general approval of the MATATAG streamlined structure, but this was later followed by a loss of confidence as challenges

in task management and insufficient training became clear. It reflects a typical pattern in education reform and strong beginnings marked by enthusiasm, followed by slow progress and limited long-term change.

Although the studies differ in their methods, they agree on several key points. Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) used qualitative research to explore how teachers adapt their strategies when faced with limited resources. In contrast, Gumilao and Langam (2025) applied pretest-posttest designs to determine professional learning outcomes. Aquino (2024) added an assessment model for classroom alignment. Despite these advancements, research remains insufficient. There have only been a few long-term or results-based studies that have looked at how the reform affects literacy. Without regular evaluations that link Grade 7 English teaching to student progress, MATATAG might not last long and might be more about politics than about making a real difference in the education system.

Comparisons with other Asian countries in the ASEAN back this review. Indraprasta and Pawiro (2023) describe how the Merdeka and Independent curricula in Indonesia have instituted teacher feedback loops and retraining mechanisms to sustain reforms. (Lahiya et al., 2025) emphasize that professional development in Vietnam has been gradually developed over the years with government support, and that Singapore has built evaluation cycles into its reform, making them essential to successful reform. On the other hand, the system of governance instability in the Philippines, its decentralization, and the fragmentation of funding pose a threat to the sustainability of the reform and the development of teacher capacity.

To sum up, the MATATAG English Curriculum encompasses good ideas, with a more student-centered approach and a clearer focus on skills. The main obstacle is bridging the gap between what the curriculum aims to achieve and what actually happens in classrooms, which will require ongoing teacher development, institutional support, and careful tracking of progress

through performance-based measures. Important steps include providing teachers with protected time to plan, establishing regular feedback cycles, and encouraging teamwork through peer observation. How Grade 7 English teachers respond to these efforts will help determine whether MATATAG can result in long-lasting change or merely replicate previous reform patterns.

Teacher's Role in Curriculum Implementation

Teachers play an important role in carrying out the curriculum, serving as the bridge between national policy and classroom practice. According to Katshuna and Shikalepo (2023), reforms are rarely followed exactly as planned; teachers often adjust to fit their classrooms and meet the needs of diverse students. Similarly, Alvarado and Galigao (2024) argue that the success of reform depends on teachers' capacity to reconcile official standards with students' immediate needs. Teacher agency is one of the essentials for realizing the reform. The Philippines' MATATAG curriculum supports this idea but also reveals ongoing challenges. Loza (2024) found that although teachers preferred a simpler design for MATATAG, many lacked training to use it effectively.

According to Batonghinog and Chavez (2025), teacher confidence and adherence to curriculum standards are strongly influenced by ongoing professional development and institutional support. Rather than relying solely on individual efforts, training institutions must take the lead in providing structured, consistent training programs to ensure effective implementation. Caballero et al., (2025) found that teachers, especially those working in inclusive classrooms, face challenges such as limited resources and diverse student needs. Their study shows that institutional support and available resources directly affect student achievement. Jamero and Accad (2025) reported a strong positive relationship ($r = 0.694$, $p < 0.01$) between administrative support and teacher effectiveness. This suggests that teacher motivation and instructional quality improve through structured mentoring and ongoing training. Overall, the research confirms that

teacher skills are closely linked to student performance in reading and communication, aligning with the goals of the MATATAG English Curriculum.

Teachers' ability to modify, accommodate, and adapt their instruction plays a crucial role in ensuring faithful curriculum implementation and enhancing student achievement in Grade 7 English classrooms. Hanum and Dalimunte (2025) demonstrated that the Indonesia Merdeka Curriculum provided teachers with autonomy and feedback, which enhanced the continuous enhancement of teaching. Vietnam reformed gradually, supported by ongoing training, whereas Singapore incorporated curriculum review and evaluation into its governance to ensure uniformity. In contrast, education reforms in the Philippines are marked by political instability, uneven funding, and decentralization, which make it difficult to maintain consistent teacher training and regular monitoring. Several studies support these findings. Demate et al., (2025) found that teachers used collaborative strategies to manage challenges in implementing MATATAG, demonstrating professional flexibility. Monton and Ducot (2025) reported that strong leadership and frequent supervision improved the teaching of competencies. However, there is still a lack of long-term research linking these practices to measurable gains in students' reading, writing, and speaking skills.

In conclusion, teachers act as both instructional leaders and cultural mediators, linking the goals of the MATATAG Curriculum to daily classroom teaching. Their success depends on regular training, clear school policies, and strong support from school leaders. However, problems with the system have dampened initial enthusiasm, and there are still few studies tracking long-term results. To fill these gaps, teachers need ongoing training and regular evaluations to see if Grade 7 English lessons under MATATAG truly lead to lasting improvements in student learning.

Challenges In Implementing Curriculum Reforms

The challenges teachers face in adapting to curriculum changes have been a topic of concern at both the local and global levels. Teachers experienced challenges in the previous reforms, including K-12, which continued despite policy changes. Casimiro et al., (2021) found that high workloads and insufficient training weaken teachers' capacity to maintain student engagement. Similarly, Abdullah et al., (2025) stated that English teachers experienced resource shortages and overcrowded lessons, leading them to resort to improvisation rather than planned lessons. Aslam et al., (2024) and Karakuş (2021) reported that a loaded curriculum, poor professional education, and inadequate institutional support are failures in the implementation process.

The same problems can be found under the MATATAG Curriculum, but in different forms. Loza (2024) found that teachers simplified standards; however, many were unsure how to implement them without ongoing training. Elardo (2025) reported an imbalance in teacher preparation due to the absence of specialized development programs and guidelines. According to Maraveles and Ducot (2025), teachers were unable to achieve the reform goals due to heavy workloads and limited classroom resources. As noted by Cruz et al., (2025), these pressures increased stress levels, reducing motivation and teaching energy. Jelongos and Naanep (2025) stated that high workloads and reduced classroom engagement are trends that hinder student development. These results indicate that the barriers are not only due to practical constraints but also to institutional gaps in support and policy implementation. Possible solutions were illuminated through comparative studies.

Internationally, the reform and national retraining in Vietnam were conducted in advance. The implementation was maintained by the continuous review cycles and accountability systems in Singapore. Hanum and Dalimunte (2025) found that feedback loops and retraining are

incorporated into the Merdeka Curriculum in Indonesia to enable teachers to adapt. Compared to this, political changes, lopsided decentralization, and the lack of organized funding still threaten the reform process in the Philippines. These boundaries force educators to work with minimal support, leaving them burnt out and resorting to short-term, unsustainable solutions. These institutional inadequacies have first-order consequences on students. Literacy, especially in reading comprehension and communication, remains low in the Philippines.

In situations with high teacher stress, limited teacher preparation, and minimal resources, classroom engagement is reduced and learning is impaired. The MATATAG curriculum aims to enhance literacy and communication, and it would otherwise be incomplete and deficient without constant surveillance and data analysis. There is the problem of cultural and linguistic diversity. Torrefiel et al., (2025) found that teachers in multilingual, rural schools are frequently deprived of resources to meet students' background requirements. Similarly, Hatmanto and Rahmawati (2023) stated that without proper training, teachers struggle to meet diverse learning needs, potentially creating gaps between urban and rural learners. These findings highlight the importance of linguistic inclusivity and cultural awareness in implementing the MATATAG Curriculum to ensure fair access to education.

Recent studies by Bazar (2025) and Torrefiel et al., (2025) are limited in duration; they yield qualitative data on teachers' experiences and adaptation strategies. Jamero and Accad (2025) conducted a quantitative study that pinpointed essential school and leadership factors affecting implementation. Malinao and Miano (2025) used a mixed-methods approach; their results require additional validation. In general, not many studies have looked at reforms over a long period of time or found clear links between the problems teachers face and improvements in student learning that can be measured. When used effectively, these strategies help improve reading,

writing, and speaking skills, which are key areas of literacy in the MATATAG Curriculum. In the Philippines, regional examples offer valuable insights for educational development.

Bucal and Pawilen (2025) advise that responsive teaching techniques are needed to ensure Indigenous learners are incorporated in the MATATAG Curriculum. Unless lessons and instruction are adjusted to local contexts, English instruction may give urban and English-speaking students an unfair advantage over those in multilingual contexts. In this situation, teachers mediate cultural aspects rather than strictly follow the curriculum, and they can help bridge the gap between language and context that influences student learning. Although studies present various strategies, they also share common insights into the relevance of inclusive, context-sensitive teaching structures. Gulmayo and Subillaga (2025) provide qualitative evidence of adaptive literacy practices, while Cape and Subillaga (2025) offer quantitative proof that grammar-integrated lessons improve performance. Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) employ a mixed-methods approach to investigate the relationship between teaching styles and students' motivation and communication skills. However, only a few long-term or results-based studies examine lasting progress in literacy. Without strong evaluation that links teaching methods to clear learning outcomes, the success of reforms often relies more on opinions than on proven results.

In conclusion, effective English instruction under the MATATAG Curriculum requires the use of communicative, context-based, and culturally responsive methods that follow curriculum standards. Teaching has shifted from inconsistent K–12 practices to more flexible, student-focused approaches. However, strong institutional support remains important. To apply best practices, it is recommended to establish formal teacher retraining programs, build stable governance systems, and incorporate regular evaluation processes. To bridge the research gap, the impact of teaching changes should be measured in long-term studies funded. These steps offer a good roadmap for moving adaptive teaching from a temporary feature to a permanent part of the teaching process.

Teaching Practices in English Instruction

Curriculum goals are shaped by how teachers teach in the classroom, which in turn affects how well students learn to read and write. In the old K–12 curriculum, teaching was not the same for all students. Cabrera et al., (2023) discovered that the reading lessons lacked clear continuity, leaving gaps in students' knowledge. As mentioned by Tumala (2024), the strict spiral progression acted as an impediment to allowing the teacher to adjust the lesson to various levels of skills. The findings highlight that MATATAG needs to change to student-centered, competency-based instruction with emphasis on actual mastery. Based on this requirement, recent studies on MATATAG implementation show that adaptive instructional practices align with English curriculum objectives. Dignos and Mangindra (2025) found that oral/silent reading enhanced understanding and interest among Grade 7 students. According to Gulmayo and Subillaga (2025), teachers resorted to scaffolding and group work to train readers. In contrast, Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) emphasize the importance of collaborative learning and real-life communication activities to develop fluency. Cape and Subillaga (2025) verify that the introduction of grammar teaching to the literature lessons increased the accuracy and comprehension of language.

Combined, the practices are an indication of a transition towards communication-oriented practices that are integrated and align with the standards of MATATAG. Ambitious ideas, inconsistent execution, and constant shifts have marked the Philippines' curriculum reform. All the reforms, such as the K-12 program and the present MATATAG Curriculum, represent the nation's ongoing efforts to enhance education and address historical gaps in teacher training, governing policies, and student performance. The K to 12 reform, regarded as a significant change, was diluted by flaws in its organization and a lack of competence in its implementation (Malbas et al., 2023). As observed by Barrot (2023), excessive content and a lack of teacher preparation undermined the purpose of developing future-ready learners.

These problems contributed to the corrective change. DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024 introduced the MATATAG Curriculum. It will streamline competencies, eliminate redundancies, and harmonize learning objectives with the lifelong learning core competencies. Estrellado (2023) mentioned one of the primary improvements in MATATAG, decongestion, and emphasized that it was aimed at reducing overload on the content, returning teaching to core skills, and providing teachers with more time to develop students' reading and communication skills.

According to Diquito (2024), there were initial improvements in the clarity of subjects, particularly science, with more competent classrooms leading to increased focus in teaching and improved alignment of goals and classroom tests. Similarly, Kilag et al., (2024) found that MATATAG is a significant advancement in K-12 education, with its learner-centered, context-based content being more specific and flexible to classroom teaching needs. However, reforms in the Philippine education system have tended to be influenced by political changes rather than regularly reviewed based on evidence. The long-term success of MATAG will presumably rely on mechanisms of continuous evaluation, excellent teacher education, and policy continuity across leadership transitions. The current available studies on curriculum change in the Philippines are general and differ in quality and depth. According to Aguas (2020), the success of reform depends on how teachers and school leaders understand and implement policy objectives in their schools. Nengasca (2025) also emphasized that successful implementation requires proper direction, continuous encouragement, and alignment between policy objectives and classroom practice. A combination of these studies reveals that teachers attempt to support reform, but gaps in training and coordination prevent its uniform application across schools. On the system level, Barrot (2019) and Galaura and Simpal (2025) provide helpful information, although their results are primarily descriptive. Barrot (2019) detected continuous breaks in the flow of subjects, correspondence between assessment and teaching, and coherence, and (Galaura and Simpal 2025) attributed

poorer teaching quality to the scarcity of resources and excessive workload. Nevertheless, they both relied on cross-sectional data, which limits their ability to track long-term learning outcomes.

This research trend matters because it shows we need to keep checking, using real data, to see if reforms like MATATAG are helping students improve. However, national and regional assessments such as PISA (2018) and SEA-PLM indicate that the Philippines continues to underperform in literacy and numeracy, suggesting that there remains a gap between the objectives of reform and significant learning outcomes. Although reforms such as K-12 and MATATAG have been implemented, students' reading and writing scores remain among the lowest worldwide, particularly in Grade 7 English. On the whole, these results indicate the absence of long-term, evidence-based systems that would link curriculum changes to actual gains in literacy, forcing policymakers to rely on aggregated national data rather than classroom outcomes.

In Southeast Asia, the MATATAG Curriculum aligns with regional trends toward adaptable learning models and competency-based learning. Merdeka Curriculum of Indonesia focuses on teacher autonomy, teaching in context, and continuous professional development to enhance literacy and communication (Indraprasta and Pawiro, 2023). Vietnam implemented its reform in steps, backed by ongoing teacher development, so that the reform would be ready before implementation. Singapore works through regular curriculum reviews that incorporate assessment data to ensure policy and practice are aligned. These local cases demonstrate that reform can be successfully implemented only with the support of a stable government, sustained financing, and effective oversight. Conclusively, the MATATAG Curriculum is a reaction to the overindulgence of the K to 12 program, where more content is cut, learning becomes relevant, and teachers are empowered as the main reform measures.

In conclusion, with the current lapses in teacher training, classroom management, and political stability, its success continues to be jeopardized. A lack of long-term, outcome-based

information and a poorly defined evaluation system limit attempts to assess whether MATATAG enhances literacy, particularly in English. The reform should be evidence-based, built on teacher development and institutional support, and designed to deliver actual outcomes for policymakers. Also, Grade 7 English teachers, being the primary connection between policy and classroom practice, will determine whether the teaching goals of MATAG result in observable improvements in student learning and communication skills.

Adaptations And Instructional Innovations by the Teachers

The literacy curriculum should be achieved through the application of practical teaching areas. The K-12 system has negatively affected student learning performance due to the lack of instructional practices. Cabrera et.al., (2023) found that reading instruction often lacked progression, which reduced learners' performance. According to Tumala (2024), adherence to a spiral progression prevented teachers from attending to learners of different abilities. These results highlight the importance of applying the MATATAG Curriculum through skills-based, student-centered instruction that emphasizes mastery.

Recent reports on the MATATAG Curriculum show that flexible teaching methods align with the objectives of the English curriculum. Dignos and Mangindra (2025) discovered that oral and silent reading helped Grade 7 students better comprehend and participate in the process. Similarly, Gulmayo and Subillaga (2025) find that scaffolded reading conditions and group research enhanced students' reading. In addition, Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) have highlighted the importance of team learning and activities for gaining fluency. According to Cape and Subillaga (2025), grammar practice incorporated into the lessons improved understanding and accuracy. Such solutions are a sign of a shift towards integrated teaching strategies that adhere to the MATATAG standards. The strategies will be useful for enhancing reading comprehension, writing

fluency, and oral communication, as part of the fundamental literacy competencies of the MATATAG Curriculum, when effectively executed.

Internationally, Indonesia's Merdeka Curriculum teacher feedback helps improve instruction (Hanum and Dalimunte, 2025). Vietnam's reform focuses on implementing national retraining, while Singapore relies on continuous assessment to shape its curriculum. On the other hand, there are still some issues in the Philippines regarding decentralization, political transfers, and teacher financing. To overcome these issues and ensure the long-term success of the MATATAG Curriculum, one can create professional development courses, establish a school-wide feedback process to improve the work, and ensure a stable budget for long-term professional support for teachers and motivation. The steps can be used to enable effective, homogeneous teaching across different learning environments. Cultural and language contexts also determine instruction. According to Bucal and Pawilen (2025), employing Indigenous learners in MATATAG must take into account practices that do not disrespect local cultures to be effectively inclusive. In the absence of such adaptation, the English classes will serve the interests of urban, English-dominant pupils at the expense of rural or bilingual pupils. In this position, teachers act as cultural guides, helping link language and context to make the learning process more meaningful for students.

Although these studies use different methods, they share key insights. (Gulmayo and Subillaga, 2025) provide qualitative data on adaptive literacy practices, but quantitative data on grammar-integrated lessons as less effective are provided by Cape and Subillaga (2025). Hernandez and Ngilangil (2025) use a mixed-methods approach to examine the relationships among teaching styles, student motivation, and communication skills. Nevertheless, few long-term outcome studies follow literacy outcomes. The success of reform is more dependent on perception than on

evidence, unless a large-scale evaluation is carried out that can associate the teaching method with measurable changes.

In conclusion, the MATATAG Curriculum aims to achieve effective English instruction through teaching methods that focus on communication, context, and culture, aligned with curriculum standards. Teaching has shifted from fragmented K–12 models to more adaptive, student-centered approaches, but strong institutional support remains essential. Best practices have to be incorporated to do this; therefore, formal teacher retraining programs have to be established, stable governance structures have to be developed, and systems of continuous assessment have to be incorporated. To seal the gap, long-term research is needed to trace the effects of instructional innovations. These measures provide an easy road to adapting teaching as one of the long-lasting aspects of development in the teaching field.

Impact Of Teachers' Adaptations on Classroom Instruction and Learning

Teachers' adaptations are key to connecting the intended curriculum to the final learning outcomes. In the MATATAG Curriculum, these changes affect how reforms are implemented in the classroom and how students respond to instruction. According to Cachero (2025), teachers' ability to adapt teaching strategies to local needs greatly influences how well students stay engaged and understand the lessons. Similarly, Balansag et al. (2024) conclude that flexible teaching methods led to measurable improvements in student performance. It shows that education policies can be translated into classroom practice when teachers are flexible and aware of their teaching context.

When teachers adapt their instruction to students' needs, they improve lesson delivery and support literacy in English instruction. Gulmayo and Subillaga (2025) discovered that differences in reading methods and applicable lessons increased comprehension and engagement among Grade 7 students. Dignos and Mangindra (2025) stated that combining oral and silent reading was more effective in developing fluency. Also, Lipom et al., (2025) identified that using

technology in lessons was more motivating. These results highlight the shift of the curriculum to digital and student-centered learning. Their combined demonstration is that adaptive techniques increase interaction and literacy. Additionally, teachers' flexibility makes instruction robust despite restrictions.

Saro et al. (2024) point out that teachers' role is to interpret the curriculum based on students' needs and resources and to modify the pacing and structure. Bergado and Ventura (2025) found that a growth mindset and resilience enable teachers to remain effective when the workload is heavy. As Po (2025) demonstrates, a lack of training and support can be compensated for by adaptation. The studies support these findings, showing that adaptation serves both as a coping strategy and as a means of keeping teaching aligned with learning goals.

Adaptation is directly related to student engagement and achievement. Cerezo et al., (2025) found that students who received modified, relevant instruction performed better on written and hands-on tasks. Uy et al., (2024) found that literacy and numeracy improved when teachers used materials relevant to students' lives. Marzo and Velasco (2025) observed that there existed a close correlation between improved performance ratings and the adaptive skills of teachers. These findings show that adaptive teaching improves learning quality and enhances classroom dynamics. However, the distinction between adaptations and official standards depends on the situation.

According to Po (2025) it may result in unequal curriculum implementation and unequal student achievement. Competencies are simplified or modified by teachers in an attempt to save time (Cachero, 2025). It says that although the teacher's freedom fosters innovation, careless monitoring and guidance may prompt the teacher to act beyond the intended goal, and that the arguments for the necessity of clear frameworks that balance flexibility and adherence to curriculum objectives are compelling.

To sum up, teachers' adaptation of the MATATAG Curriculum influences their success, engagement levels, and teaching quality. Teachers incorporate policy into practice by modifying standards, differentiating lessons, and adopting new approaches, which influence the level and quality of English learning, particularly in comprehension, writing fluency, and communication fluency.

Operational Transition

Implementation of MATATAG indicates that classroom practices of teachers are always found to be heavily dependent on the support and transition mechanisms that are provided to them. Demate (2025) has discovered that, although teachers consider the MATATAG Curriculum more relevant and briefer compared to the previous one, the teaching in the public schools is especially difficult due to the overwhelming quantity of curriculum, administrative, and resource limitations. As a result, they argue in favor of differentiated training and resource enrichment and collaborative learning conditions to keep the implementation.

Likewise, Dadul (2025) presented the opinions of the elementary teachers on MATAG, stating that it is necessary to clarify the rules and provide more resources and ongoing professional development to overcome the change from the past curriculum. By concentrating on the English curriculum, Lastimosa and Dagandon (2025) revealed that the transformative ambitions of the MATATAG English 7 curriculum can be realized only if teachers are systematically supported through a system of professional development, provision of resources, and a participatory implementation structure.

The implementation of English Grades 4 and 7 complementary evidence will indicate that lesson exemplars and curriculum guides, although effective, cannot work alone but need contextualized training and technical school-based support to effectively target classroom instruction in MATATAG English. Through these studies, a clear pattern emerges that educators demand systematic and continuous assistance. A blend of training, resources, group effort, and

criticism that provides a thick empirical foundation to the designing of a transition initiative clearly associated with their real practice of classroom teaching.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

The implementation of the MATATAG English curriculum falls within the cross-section of educational changes that focus on systemic and classroom-level change. The theories employed in this research will describe the process by which teachers negotiate the complex orders of such reforms and implement curriculum policies in practice. To gain clearer insight into the challenges, practices, and strategies of transition, the research will also draw on two complementary theories: Fullan's Change Theory and Shulman's Pedagogical Content Knowledge (PCK) Framework. The appropriateness of these ideas captures the dimensions of curriculum implementation in systemic and organizational contexts, which are regularly shaped by teacher adaptation and by instructional knowledge that drives classroom-level practices.

Fullan's Change Theory

Michael Fullan's conceptual idea is anchored on the premise of system-oriented curriculum reforms. This lens discusses educational change in nonlinear ways and is complex, requiring the deliberate alignment of teacher capacity, school culture, and leadership (Fullan, 2007). The success of reforms in the educational process, therefore, is highly determined by three interrelated factors: building teacher capacity through continuous professional learning, supplying resources and organizational support, and a culture of collaboration that makes teachers agents of change. Teachers in this level are not mere implementers but active professionals who shape and interpret the curricular directives in their classroom contexts.

Capacity building accordingly involves the deliberate development of teachers' skills, knowledge, and professional dispositions to meet new demands in the profession (Fullan, 2007). Professional development, access to resources, and time allocation are important inclusions. In

the MATATAG curriculum transition program, capacity-building is essential to the effective design and implementation of the curriculum.

Teacher Agency and Moral Purpose, on the other hand, talks about the role of teachers as active participants and interpreters of reform. They cannot be just passive followers of the policy (Biesta et al., 2015). The agency occurs when educators make decisions regarding the conduct of the lessons, serving various learners, and producing contextual materials. It is essential for investigating teachers' implementation practices during the transition to MATATAG. The teacher agency ensures that the implementation of the curriculum does not cut across all teachers, while remaining aware of the requirements of various learners. Lastly, the contextual and organizational conditions address the change that has been incorporated into the school's culture, leadership, and collaboration. (Fullan, 2007) explains that leaders who support and create a culture of collaboration mediate sustainable reforms. It is connected to the way school managers can recognize issues in curriculum support and implementation. Some significant obstacles in this regard include a lack of leadership support, pressure from the workload, and poor coordination. These concepts should be addressed early in the implementation of the curriculum. Fullan's theory helps explain the challenges teachers face in curriculum implementation. It also justifies the need for systemic strategies in designing a transition program. However, the theory does not capture the dimensions of teaching—the actual practices through which teachers deliver content. Therefore, a second theory is needed.

Pedagogical Content Knowledge

Lee Shulman's concept of Pedagogical Content Knowledge (PCK) highlights that effective teaching goes beyond mastery of the subject matter. Accordingly, teachers must be able to

transform content into comprehensible input for learners. It encompasses the selection of examples, the forecasting of student myths, and the decision on how an instruction should be adapted to accommodate the needs of diverse students (Lee Shing et al., 2013). The framework studies teachers' use of curriculum in classroom learning. The theory assumptions used in this study will be content knowledge, Pedagogical knowledge, and Pedagogical content knowledge.

Content knowledge (CK) -deals with the mastery of the subject matter itself. Teachers with deep CK can accurately represent their subject's content and respond to their students' needs (Lee Shing et al., 2013). PCK assumes that good teaching starts with the blend of content knowledge and pedagogical understanding of how to utilize this content. In the teaching of English, providing comprehensible input and knowledge of grammar, vocabulary, syntax, literary genres, communication, and discourse conventions is crucial. Teachers ought to have a strong command of the concepts to impart knowledge and determine their students' needs. Without solid content knowledge, the most creative teaching paradigm would lead to misrepresentation of subject matter. It leads to student misconceptions and superficial learning.

Pedagogical Knowledge (PK) - This is the teacher's broad knowledge of the teaching and learning process. Learning theories, classroom management, instructional strategies, and assessment methods are very fundamental and require deep knowledge to provide instruction.

(Lee Shing et al., 2013; Phillips, 2014). For teachers transitioning to the new curriculum, PK is demonstrated through the design of learning environments that foster motivation, effective management of diverse classroom behaviours, and adaptation of instruction to varied learning styles and needs. PK provides an understanding of the "how" of teaching by ensuring lessons are delivered in ways that promote engagement and deep learning.

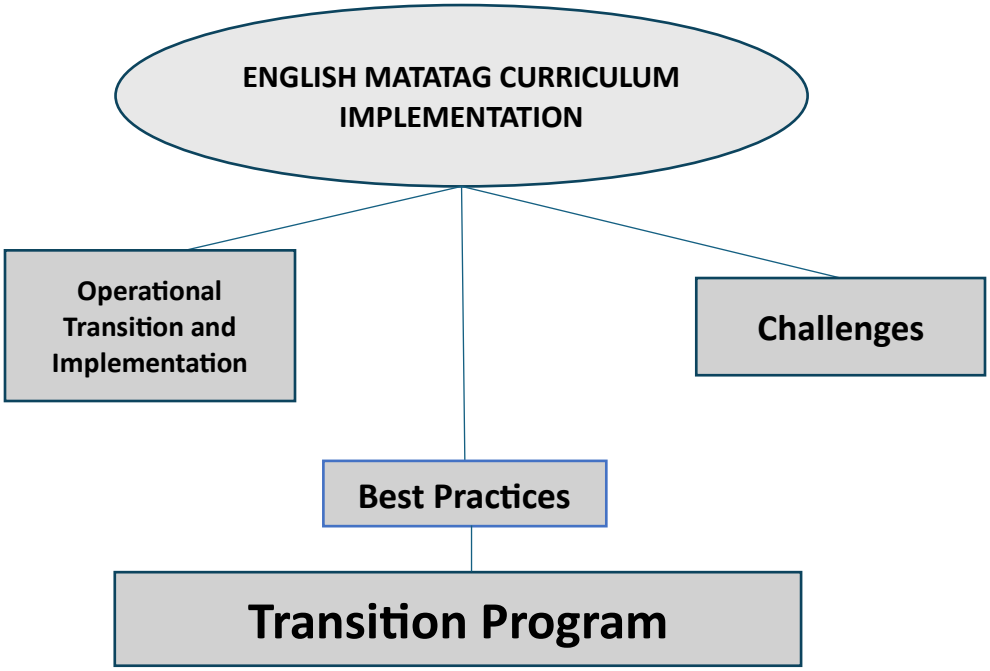
Pedagogical Content Knowledge (PCK) - This is the overlap between CK and PK, including the distinctive knowledge that a teacher, as an expert in the field of subject matter, brings to students

who have not undergone any teaching training (Lee Shing et al, 2013). Knowledge of the content and the ways to convey lessons is PCK. Content is reformatted for learners to read and comprehend. The subject matter is converted into easily accessible, comprehensible forms for learners. It involves arriving at the illusion of misconceptions, choosing the right illustrations, and adapting explanations according to the levels of the learners. PCK is evolving and adapting, providing experience and professional growth because teachers never cease to examine their practices.

In summary, content knowledge provides the "what", pedagogical knowledge is the "how", and pedagogical content knowledge integrates the two concepts and answers the "how to teach the specific content to specific individuals". For this research, the effective implementation of the MATATAG curriculum is based not only on the teacher's mastery of English but also on the ability to select appropriate strategies, anticipate needs, and create meaningful experiences.

In essence, Fullan's theory provides a macro-level understanding of reform and systemic processes. Meanwhile, PCK, as defined by Shulman, provides a micro-level description of how teachers implement changes in their everyday activities. The theories used together provide a comprehensive perspective on the implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum, as they reflect the structural impediments and teaching practices that shape English instruction in the Philippine basic education department.

1.4 Schematic Diagram



1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study aims to explore the Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide among Grade 7 English teachers. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following objectives:

1. To identify the challenges encountered by Grade 7 English Teachers in implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.
2. To describe the operational transition and implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum guide in their classroom instruction.
3. To identify the best teaching practices of Grade 7 English Teachers in catering to the diverse needs of students while following the curriculum guide.
4. To create a transition program that best aligns with implementation practices for teachers in classroom instruction.

1.6. Scope and Limitations

This study focuses on Grade 7 English teachers implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide in selected empowered public and private secondary schools located in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte. It examines their practices, challenges, and adaptations during the School Year 2024–2025. The scope will be limited to the identified research sites, and any other grade levels, subjects, or schools beyond the set parameters will not be involved. Any issues about students' performance, school management, or other subjects will not be covered. Teachers' experiences implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum guide will be the main focus. The information will be gathered through interviews. The research location will be selected purposively by the researchers, based on convenience and proximity, thereby enabling firsthand, concrete information on the application of the MATATAG English Curriculum.

1.7 Definition of Terms

To ensure conceptual precision and clarity in the use of these terms, which are operationally defined for this study, the following terms were used:

- **Challenges.** Refer to the measurable and context-specific barriers that hinder Grade 7 English teachers from effectively implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.
- **Curriculum:** A systematic collection of learning standards, learning competencies, and learning objectives that help to direct the teaching and learning. This paper has been relevant to the model that teachers apply in planning and delivering English instruction in accordance with the MATATAG reform.
- **Curriculum Guide.** Refers to the formal document of the Department of Education that defines the learning competencies, content standards, and performance standards of every subject. It is the primary source for Grade 7 English teachers to adopt lessons aligned with the MATATAG Curriculum.

- **Curriculum Implementation.** Means the process through which Grade 7 English teachers can be observed to be systematic and convert competencies, standards, and pedagogical intentions of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide into actual classroom practice.
- **Instructional Practices.** Refer to the detailed teaching methods and classroom practices of the teachers to meet the learning goals of the MATATAG English Curriculum, with the focus on communicative competence and literacy development.
- **K to 12 Curriculum.** Refers to the former Philippine national curriculum, which was used to improve basic education by adding more grades and spiral development. It will be used in the study as a reference point for identifying gaps and the improvements the MATATAG Curriculum has addressed.
- **MATATAG Curriculum.** Describes the redesigned curriculum brought in by DepEd Order No. 010, s. 2024, with a focus on decongested learning standards, foundational literacy, and contextualised instruction. It is the main issue of discussion in this research.
- **MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.** Specifically, to the English element of the MATATAG Curriculum, which identifies the competencies and the anticipated learning outcomes of Grade 7 English. It forms the basis for teachers' planning and delivery.
- **Teacher Adaptation.** Means the planned instructional changes, contextual adaptations, as well as new practices that Grade 7 English teachers use to make sure that the implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide is effective. Teacher adaptation in this paper includes the ways teachers restructure lessons, differentiate teaching methods, and design localised learning resources in response to the needs of diverse learners, scarce or limited teaching resources, and institutional factors.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents the research design, locale, respondents, research instruments, ethical standards, data-gathering procedure, and data analysis plan. These components collectively describe the systematic process that guided the conduct of the study entitled "Exploring Teachers' Implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide".

2.1 Research Design

This study will use a descriptive qualitative research design to explore how Grade 7 English teachers implement the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide. According to Creswell and David Creswell (2022), qualitative research focuses on exploring and understanding the meanings individuals or groups give to their experiences. It involves gathering data in natural settings and analyzing it inductively to identify themes and interpretations. This design fits the purpose of the study, which is to describe teachers' challenges, practices and adaptation in applying the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide in their actual classroom contexts.

Within this qualitative approach, the study specifically applies the descriptive method, which, as Creswell and David Creswell (2022) explain, involves examining the data closely, using limited interpretation, and organizing the information into themes that reflect participants' real experiences. This method is appropriate because it emphasizes describing what teachers do, how they implement the curriculum, and the situations that influence their practices.

The descriptive qualitative design allows the researcher to highlight participants' genuine thoughts and experiences in their own words, rather than relying on abstract or theoretical explanations. It uses multiple data sources, such as interviews, and observations to gain a deeper understanding of teachers' work. Instead of testing hypotheses, this design organizes teachers' experiences into meaningful themes that show how they apply and adapt the curriculum in real settings.

(Creswell and David Creswell 2022) outline several key steps in qualitative data collection and analysis, which include:



By following these steps, the study ensures that data collection is organized, ethical, and credible. The descriptive qualitative design is the most suitable for this research because it highlights the real experiences of Grade 7 English teachers and provides a clear picture of how they practice, face challenges, and make adaptations in implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

The main research instrument will be a structured interview guide. The structured interview guide will contain open-ended questions designed by the researchers and validated by experts in curriculum studies and English education. To ensure data credibility, the study will employ document analysis of lesson plans to support and validate the findings from the structured interviews.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

Research Locale

The study will be conducted in selected empowered public and private secondary schools located in the municipalities of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte. The schools that will be conduct are those that follow the MATATAG Curriculum guide.

Research Respondents

The respondents of the study will be the Grade 7 English teachers currently teaching under the MATATAG English Curriculum in the identified public and private secondary schools of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen. A total of (12) selected empowered schools, and (17) teachers who experienced the implementation of the MATATAG curriculum guide.

Table 1. Distributions of Respondents by School and Municipality.

Municipality	School	Number of Teachers
Buenavista	Saint James High School	3
	Buenavista Special Education High School	1
	Buenavista National High School	1
	Buenavista Institute	1

Nasipit	Saint Michael College of Caraga	1
	Nasipit National Vocational School	4
	Northwestern Agusan Colleges	1
	Calixto D. Montinola National High School	1
	Culit National High School	1
Carmen	Carmen National High School	1
	Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga Incorporated	1
	Cahayagan National High School	1

Research Sampling

The researchers will use purposive sampling, selecting participants based on their direct, active involvement in implementing the curriculum. Respondents will include teachers with at least 2 years of teaching experience and exposure to DepEd MATATAG training programs. This sampling method is deemed appropriate as it allows the researchers to deliberately choose individuals who possess firsthand insights relevant to the research objectives.

Research Instrument

The researchers will use a structured interview guide as the main instrument for data collection. The interview guide will contain organized questions developed by the researchers and validated by experts to ensure clarity and relevance to the study. The questions will be designed to encourage participants to share their challenges, practices, and adaptations in implementing the MATATAG Curriculum Guide.

To ensure the credibility of the instrument, expert validation will be conducted to confirm that the questions are appropriate, understandable, and capable of obtaining the information required to address the research objectives.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Data Gathering Procedure

The researcher will prepare the data collection by fulfilling all requirements before conducting the interviews with the respondents. In accordance with institutional protocols, a letter of approval will be obtained from the school and the participating teachers. Informed consent forms and authorization letters will be sent to respondents and will be collected to ensure ethical compliance in the study.

The following processes were done to ensure the accomplishment of the research goals:

1. To facilitate transparency and build trust in the study, the researcher shall inform participants of the study's purpose, objectives, and importance before the interview sessions.
2. Informed consent will be obtained from all participants by having them sign consent forms granting permission to record audio and video during the interview.
3. Ample time will be provided to them to go through the interview guide and seek clarification on any issues to make the interview comfortable and understandable.
4. Logistical preparations will be made to ensure the reliability and ethical conduct of the process by scheduling interviews and maintaining a quiet environment.
5. During the interview proper, audio or video recordings will be used with the participants' permission, and the researchers will take field notes to capture non-verbal cues, contextual details, and significant observations that support the accuracy and depth of the data.
6. All interview recordings will later be transcribed and systematically analyzed using ATLAS.ti software, which will assist in organizing, coding, and identifying emerging themes from the data.

Data Analysis

The researchers will use a descriptive qualitative design to conduct a thorough thematic analysis, following the steps outlined by Braun and Clarke (2006). This approach is appropriate for describing teachers' experiences and practices using non-numerical data gathered through interviews and discussions. The responses will be analyzed following the guide questions, with each transcription from audio and video recordings carefully read to identify relevant statements. All relevant answers will be grouped and labeled based on identified themes. The transcripts will be uploaded to ATLAS.ti software—a qualitative analysis tool used for coding and analyzing transcripts and field notes. This tool helps systematically organize, code, and identify themes.

The researchers will follow the procedures:

Step 1: Familiarizing with the Data Transcription of all recorded interviews will be done verbatim to preserve the authenticity of participants' responses. The researcher will immerse themselves in the data by repeatedly reading and listening to the transcripts to develop a comprehensive understanding of their content. Through this familiarization process, the researcher will begin forming initial insights and annotations. Using ATLAS.ti, notes and early impressions will be systematically recorded to aid later analysis.

Step 2: Generating Initial Codes The researcher will use ATLAS.ti software to systematically code the transcripts by identifying significant segments of text. Each code will represent a concise description of ideas or patterns in participants' statements. These codes will serve as the foundation for identifying broader themes that align with the study's objectives on the implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.

Step 3: Searching for Themes After coding, similar or related codes will be grouped to form preliminary themes that reflect participants' shared experiences and perspectives. ATLAS.ti network and visualization tools will help the researcher explore relationships

among codes and develop an initial thematic structure. This process allows patterns to emerge that reflect the core ideas underlying teachers' experiences, challenges, and practices.

Step 4: Reviewing Potential Themes The researcher will review and refine the emerging themes to ensure accuracy, consistency, and coherence. Each theme will be checked against the coded extracts and the original transcripts to ensure it accurately reflects the participants' meanings. Redundant or overlapping themes will be merged, while those lacking sufficient support will be modified or removed. This process ensures that the final themes remain grounded in the data.

Step 5: Defining and Naming Themes The finalized themes will be clearly defined and named to capture their essence and relevance to the research questions. Each theme will be assigned a concise, descriptive label. These definitions and names will be recorded in a thematic map and codebook generated through ATLAS. It provides an overview of how each theme connects to the study's broader narrative.

Step 6: Writing Up The last phase involves integrating the analyzed data into a comprehensive, scholarly narrative that describes the experiences of Grade 7 English teachers in implementing the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide. The researcher will present the themes alongside direct quotations from participants to support interpretations. The report will be organized around the identified themes—teachers' experiences, challenges, practices, and adaptations—offering a clear and descriptive account of how the curriculum is applied in classroom contexts. Post-Analysis Procedures: All audio recordings, transcripts, and ATLAS.ti project files will be securely stored and password-protected to maintain ethical standards, transparency, and data integrity throughout the research process.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. The Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

There will be no new technology, process, or product that needs to be patented during the research. It honours and observes intellectual property rights. To support intellectual property rights, the researcher will ensure that all materials used are properly referenced and registered under copyright law. All the third-party sources and secondary data will be duly credited. As the study will not create any brand, logo, or symbol, there is no need for trademark registration.

B. Informed Consent

The researchers will explain the purpose, procedure, risks, and benefits of the study to the respondents in simple terms before data collection. Each participant will ensure voluntary participation by signing a written consent. As the research will involve only human participants, an ethical approval will be required.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The researchers will adhere to the Republic Act No. 10173, or the Data Privacy Act of 2012, and its Implementing Rules and Regulations. To ensure the anonymity of the personal data, they will cover the names with pseudonyms. Information will be stored securely and accessed only by the authorized research team. The information obtained in the course of this research will be considered with the highest level of confidentiality in compliance with the relevant laws and regulations. The identifiable information gathered will remain in strict confidence, except where disclosure is necessary to protect your rights or well-being. This consent form will ensure that your information about participation will not be accessed by any other person who is not part of the research itself. Once the findings of this study are published or presented at conferences, your identity will not be disclosed, and no personally identifiable information will be collected.

D. Participation and Freedom of Withdrawal

The researchers will ensure that respondents are not forced into participating in the study; therefore, participation will be voluntary. The respondents will be well informed of their right to withdraw from the research at any time without any negative impact. Full approval of all responses gathered from respondents will be given, and respondents will be free to make their own choices and feel safe and comfortable throughout the study.

E. Reduction of Harm and Risk Management

The researchers will undertake several measures to mitigate potential risks and inconveniences during the study. The researchers will also make sure that the interview process is safe, respectful, and supportive. The respondents may be mildly uncomfortable with the sensitive nature of the discussion during the interview process. To reduce any potential stress, the researchers will provide clear instructions, reassurance, and encouragement to help participants feel comfortable.

Suppose any participant experiences emotional reflection or mild stress while discussing personal experiences or being observed during the activity. In circumstances where a participant becomes unresponsive, visibly uncomfortable, or emotionally distressed during the interview, the researchers will immediately pause the session and provide reassurance to the respondent. Participants will be reminded that they may skip questions, take a break, or discontinue the interview entirely without any negative consequence. If the interview triggers heightened emotional stress or professional anxiety, the researchers will refer the participant to an appropriate support system within the school, such as the Guidance Counselor, following institutional protocols. This measure ensures that respondents receive proper assistance and are not left unsupported should the interview process evoke unintended emotional discomfort.

F. Beneficence and Contribute to Knowledge

This study aims to gain valuable insights that benefit both public and private-sector administrators. The findings and discussions from this research can provide evidence to inform the implementation of the MATATAG English Curriculum Guide.

Additionally, the results of this study may be of particular interest to government agencies such as:

1. Saint Michael College of Caraga – For its ongoing commitment to enhancing the quality of education and aligning institutional practices with curriculum reforms.
2. Department of Education – For providing insights that may inform policy development and strengthen the implementation of educational programs across institutions.
3. Teachers and Educators – For helping them improve instructional strategies, address challenges in curriculum implementation, and enhance student learning outcomes.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection Participants

Selected based on their relevance to the research objectives, namely Grade 7 English teachers who use the MATATAG Curriculum. No gender, religious, socioeconomic, or institutional discrimination will be present.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

The researchers will uphold truth and accuracy in the gathering, transcribing, and analysis of data. Triangulation through interviews, and expert validation will be carried out to enhance data reliability.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting Research

The results will be presented objectively, without omission of both positive and negative results. The researchers will not falsify, exaggerate, or misrepresent data. Submission will be preceded by plagiarism checking and peer reviews.

J. Patented or Copyrighted Materials Usage

The present study will use various sources, such as copyrighted academic materials and secondary data. The researchers understand the importance of respecting intellectual property and obtaining all required permissions before using any copyrighted materials. Any resources cited in the final report will be properly cited to ensure attribution and transparency. This ethical sourcing will respect the integrity of the study and recognize the input of the original author whose writing is used to support this study.

K. Ethical Considerations of Animal and Human Trials

The study is based only on the human participants, and it follows the Philippine National Ethical Guidelines of Research Involving Humans (DOST-PCHRD, 2017). None of the animals will be experimented on.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Other Related Technologies

The researchers will take the assistance of AI tools like ChatGPT and Grammarly to help draft, edit, and check the linguistic accuracy. These tools will not replace the researchers' critical thinking, but will assist them. The researchers will manually verify all AI-generated content to ensure the ethical integrity of the research, and the data provided by participants will never be entered into unsafe AI platforms.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

The researchers will obtain ethical approval from the Institutional Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga. Consent will be used to ensure compliance with best practices for participant safety, data confidentiality, and intellectual property protection.

REFERENCES

Abaiz, Marie Christe, Jane Rose Baluro, Danise Mae Dolotallas, Lhera Mae Gimeno, Mary Joy Pomasin, and Angelito Cabanilla. 2024. "Teachers' Perspectives on Matatag Curriculum in the Philippines." *International Journal of Multidisciplinary Research and Growth Evaluation* 6(1):369–74. https://www.allmultidisciplinaryjournal.com/uploads/archives/20250106185320_F-24-170.1.pdf.

Abdullah, Mahdi B., Bai Laga S. Bantilan, Alven M. Bolotaolo, Hilda T. Delos Reyes, Guiarmiya M. Haron, and Michelle M. Uy. 2025. "Exploring the Lived Experiences of Senior High School English Teachers: Challenges, Impact and Coping Strategies in K To 12 Curriculum Implementation." *Randwick International of Education and Linguistics Science Journal* 6(2):184–97. doi:10.47175/rielsj.v6i2.1156.

Abragan, Fernan Q., Ivy Mae Aquino, Vangie Abarcas, and Rowena E. Bagongon. 2022. "Research Review on K-12 Curriculum Implementation in The Philippines: A Generic Perspective." *European Journal of Educational and Social Sciences* 7(1):1–8. doi:10.5281/zenodo.7272126.

Aguas, Pedro P. 2020. "Key Stakeholders' Lived Experiences While Implementing an Aligned Curriculum: A Phenomenological Study." *TQR WHERE THE WORLD COMES TO LEARN QUALITATIVE RESEARCH* 25(10):3459–85. doi:10.46743/2160-3715/2020.3924.

Alvarado, Carl Christopher P. 2023. "Communicative Competence in Spiral Progression Curriculum: A Study Reinforcing the Implementation of MATATAG Curriculum in the Philippines." *Journal of Humanities and Education Development* 5(6):11–29. doi:10.22161/jhed.5.6.3.

Alvarado, Joevie R., and Regina P. Galigao. 2024. "Assessing the Effectiveness of Curriculum Implementation Across Global Educational Systems." *International Multidisciplinary Journal of Research for Innovation, Sustainability, and Excellence (IMJRISE) /* 1(11):219–28. https://risejournals.org/index.php/imjrise/article/view/851.

Aquino, Eldon S. 2024. "Developing an Evaluation Scale for Assessing the Effective Implementation of Matatag Curriculum in Philippine Public Schools: Exploratory Sequential Design." *Journal of Interdisciplinary Perspectives* 2(5):167–84. doi:10.69569/JIP.2024.0074.

Aranda, Ma Rita R. 2022. "Learning Challenges in the New Senior High School English Curriculum in the Philippines." *International Journal of Learning, Teaching and Educational Research* 21(11):315–33. doi:10.26803/ijlter.21.11.18.

Aslam, Kinza, Rehan Ahmed Khan, Mohammad Annas Aslam, and Fatima Zia Zaidi. 2024. "Curriculum Implementation Challenges: Development and Validation of an Integrated Curriculum Implementation Challenges Tool." *Pakistan Journal of Medical Sciences* 40(1):89–94. doi:10.12669/PJMS.40.1.7258.

Aslam, Pakeeza, Qurratulain Mushtaq, Fraz Noor, Sania Maqbool, Nadeem Yar Khan, and Junaid Sarfraz. 2024. "The Literature Review on Curriculum Implementation

Problems." *Journal of Health and Rehabilitation Research* 4(2):497–501. doi:10.61919/JHRR.V4I2.844.

Balansag, Evangelyn G., Roneil Troy D. Garcia, Angel Fae R. Tardio, Kristel S. Sintos, and Bryan Louis G. Lazaro. 2024. "A New Era of Learning: The Matatag Curriculum and Its Impact on Fourth Grade Students' Academic Performance." *International Journal of Advanced Multidisciplinary Research and Studies* 4(6):1141–52. doi:10.62225/2583049x.2024.4.6.3565.

Barrot, Jessie S. 2019. "English Curriculum Reform in the Philippines: Issues and Challenges from a 21st Century Learning Perspective." *Journal of Language, Identity and Education* 18(3):145–60. doi:10.1080/15348458.2018.1528547;WGROUP:STRING:PUBLICATION.

Barrot, Jessie S. 2023. "K to 12 Curriculum Reform in the Philippines: Towards Making Students Future Ready." *Asia Pacific Journal of Education* 43(4):1193–1207. doi:10.1080/02188791.2021.1973959.

Batonghinog, Phoebe Joy, and Judith Chavez. 2025. "Professional Development Training and Academic Support: Predictors of Teachers' Confidence in Curriculum Change." *Journal of Interdisciplinary Perspectives* 3(7):444–53. doi:10.69569/jip.2025.327.

Bazar, Glissie Marie S. 2025. "Challenges And Coping Mechanisms Of Teachers In Transitioning To The Matatag Curriculum: A Phenomenological Study." *International Journal of Academic Pedagogical Research* 9(5):21–28. http://ijeais.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/5/IJAPR250504.pdf.

Bejasa, Rechie C. 2025. "Lived Experiences of the Public-School Teachers in the Implementation of Matatag Curriculum." *London Journal of Research in Humanities & Social Science* 25:55–68. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/389182046_Lived-Experiences-of-the-Public-School-Teachers-in-the-Implementation-of-Matatag-Curriculum.

Belga, Al-Niña, Connie Chavez, Lovely Mae Petipet, and Mae Christianne Fagutao. 2025. "What Works and What Doesn't in the K-12 Curriculum; Insights for the MATATAG Curriculum Implementation." *United International Journal for Research & Technology* 06(06):93–97. doi:UIJRTV6I60011.pdf.

Berecio, Diana Rose T., Sheila Princess M. Lambot, Stefahnie Rose A. Radaza, Jocil C. Silvano, Lou Josefa Gizelle L. Tiozon, and Lovely L. Enfermo. 2025. *Exploring Lived Experiences of Elementary Teachers in Using Differentiated Instruction within the MATATAG Curriculum*. https://animorepository.dlsu.edu.ph/conf_archers/2025/paper_educ/3/.

Bergado, Cheryl M., and Cherry Vanessa M. Ventura. 2025. "Teachers' Grit and Growth Mindset in Adopting the MATATAG Curriculum." *International Journal of Open-Access, Interdisciplinary and New Educational Discoveries of ETCOR Educational Research Center (IJOINED ETCOR)* 4(2):147–59. doi:10.63498/nxz2st264.

Bernardo, Alejandro S. 2022. "Analysis of Core Claims, Assumptions, and Silences: A Basis for Re-Designing the Enacted K-12 English Curriculum and

Reconceptualizing Communicative Competence." *Journal of English and Applied Linguistics* 1(2):1–16. doi:10.59588/2961-3094.1017.

Biesta, Gert, Mark Priestley, and Sarah Robinson. 2015. "The Role of Beliefs in Teacher Agency." *Teachers and Teaching* 21(6):624–40. doi:10.1080/13540602.2015.1044325.

Braun, Virginia, and Victoria Clarke. 2006. *Using Thematic Analysis in Psychology*.

Bucal, John Vincent J., and Greg T. Pawilen. 2025. "Pagkakasupeg Framework on Bridging Indigenous Peoples Education to MATATAG Curriculum." *International Journal of Curriculum and Instruction* 17(2):486–500. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/389502421_Pagkakasupeg_Framework_on_Bridging_Indigenous_Peoples_Education_to_MATATAG_Curriculum.

Caballero, Marifel A., Raymond C. Espina, Niña Rozanne T. Delos Reyes, Ann Frances P. Cabigon, Randy C. Mangubat, Irene O. Mamites, Divine C. Abellaneda, Angelie Therese L. Denampo, Ma. Fe M. Nourie, Mardilyn A. Sañosa, and Loriene E. Nacario. 2025. "UNRAVELLING THE CHALLENGES AND ADAPTIVE PREPAREDNESS OF PUBLIC-SCHOOL TEACHERS IN IMPLEMENTING THE MATATAG CURRICULUM WITHIN INCLUSIVE EDUCATION SETTINGS." *International Journal of Humanities Education* 13(1):804–39. https://cm.os-cgrn.org/index.php/ijhe/article/view/100.

Cabrera, Lino S., Denard V. Budao, and Eva Mae A. Canas. 2023. "BETWEEN THE LINES: THE CASE OF TEACHING READING IN THE PHILIPPINE K TO 12 CLASSROOMS." PALAWAN NATIONAL SCHOOL, PUERTO PRINCESA CITY.

Cachero, Mary Joy C. 2025. "Teachers' Practices, Challenges and Adaptive Mechanisms in the Implementation of MATATAG Curriculum." *Cognizance Journal of Multidisciplinary Studies* 5(5):715–21. doi:10.47760/cognizance.2025.v05i05.049.

Cape, Analyn S., and Rebecca D. Subillaga. 2025. "Integrated Grammar Approach in Teaching Philippine Literature and Academic Performance of MATATAG Learners." *PSYCHOLOGY AND EDUCATION: A MULTIDISCIPLINARY JOURNAL* 39(1):79–90. doi:10.70838/pemj.390109,.

Casimiro, Arvin B., Atrido Jr. T. Fortunato, and Alice A. Calahat. 2021. "Addressing Teachers' Challenges during the Implementation of the K to 12 Curriculum: Towards Providing a Motivating Learning Environment for Children." *International Journal of Early Childhood Special Education (INT-JECSE* 13:2174–81. doi:10.48047/intjecse/V13i2.211237.

Cerezo, Jade Stephanie B., Kent Lloyd M. Destajo, Charlotte D. Elicano, Den Karl G. Flores, Mary Louie E. Galaura, Manilyn C. Lapiz, Ricky Boy E. Limlingan, Maritchel L. Sanchez, Joey S. Simbajon, June Antonette C. Taglucop, Rodnie M. Tagubar, and Ian S. Umpil. 2025. "A Descriptive Analysis of Student Performance in Written Exams and Practical Tasks in Science 7 under the MATATAG Curriculum." *Cognizance Journal of Multidisciplinary Studies* 5(5):700–706. doi:10.47760/cognizance.2025.v05i05.047.

Creswell, John W., and J. David Creswell. 2022. *Research Design: Qualitative, Quantitative, and Mixed Methods Approaches*. https://books.google.com.ph/books/about/Research_Design.html?id=Pr2VEAAAQBAJ&redir_esc=y.

Cruz, Alexander, Aron John De Jesus, Catherine Joy Macaisog, Angel Ann Mamangun, Gabriella Pineda, Alex Dexter Ramos, and Noel L. Dominado. 2025. "The Perceived Stress Level of Teachers' Handling MATATAG Curriculum." *MRS Journal of Arts, Humanities and Literature* 2(3):3049–1444. doi:doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.15007439.

Demate, Dhana Rose B., Marlo S. Aclis, Fides Claire P. Catbagan, Ginalyn G. Molina, Nowel U. Ramos, and Frederick F. Patacsil. 2025. "Teacher Perspectives on MATATAG Curriculum: Challenges and Collaborative Solutions." https://www.malque.pub/ojs/index.php/mr/article/view/8311/3850.

Dignos, Jayson T., and Anesa P. Mangindra. 2025. "Oral and Silent Reading and Its Effect on Reading Comprehension Levels of Grade 7 Students Under the MATATAG Curriculum." *International Journal of Arts, Sciences and Education* 6(2):1–17. https://www.ijase.org/index.php/ijase/article/view/447.

Diquito, Tomas Jr. 2024. "Basic Education Curriculum under the Newly Implemented K to 10 (MATATAG) Curriculum in the Philippines: The Case of Science Education." *American Journal of Education and Technology* 3(3):123–32. doi:10.54536/AJET.V3I3.3396.

Elardo, Ana Liza A. 2025. "Teachers' Preparedness, Needs and Challenges in the Implementation of Matatag Curriculum." *Cognizance Journal of Multidisciplinary Studies* 5(5):334–37. doi:10.47760/cognizance.2025.v05i05.020.

Estrellado, Carie Justine P. 2023. "MATATAG Curriculum: Why Curriculum [Must] Change?" *Journal of Interdisciplinary Perspectives* 2(1):6–10. doi:10.69569/JIP.2024.0001.

Fullan, Michael. 2007. *The New Meaning of Educational Change*. 4th ed. Teachers College Press.

Galaura, Rona Joy A., and Ebrahim Alpe A. Simpal. 2025. "Challenges in the Implementation of K to 12 Program and Their Influence on the Instructional Competence of Teachers." *International Journal of Interdisciplinary Viewpoints* 1(2):121–32. doi:10.5281/zenodo.15528141.

Gaudicos, Adel Grace P., Osias Kit T. Kilag, Yancy Maria Dayola, Henry B. Wagas, Francisca T. Uy, and Yola Marie T. Dela Cerna. 2024. "MATATAG Curriculum: Bridging Global Competencies and Filipino Values in Philippine Education." *International Multidisciplinary Journal of Research for Innovation, Sustainability, and Excellence (IMJRISE)* 1(9):148–54. Keywords: MATATAG Curriculum, 21st Century Skills, Holistic Development, Educational Reform, Philippines.

Gulmayo, Joan Kate, and Rebecca Subillaga. 2025. "Lived Experiences of Teachers and Emerging Readers in English 7 Under the MATATAG Curriculum."

Psychology and Education: A Multidisciplinary Journal 36(5):580–606. doi:10.70838/pemj.360509.

Gumilao, Jhonie, and Ronalyn T. Langam. 2025. "Assessing the Efficacy of MATATAG Curriculum Training: A Pretest-Posttest Analysis of Educators' Knowledge and Skills." *Journal of Education and Learning Reviews* 2(3):145–52. doi:10.60027/jelr.2025.1780.

Hanum, Latifah, and Ahmad Amin Dalimunte. 2025. "Challenges and Adaptations Pre-Service Efl Teachers' Perceptions on Implementing The Merdeka Curriculum In Teaching English." *Jayapangus Press Cetta: Jurnal Ilmu Pendidikan* 8(2):72–86. https://jayapanguspress.penerbit.org/index.php/cetta.

Hatmanto, Endro Dwi, and Fitria Rahmawati. 2023. "Unleashing the Potential: Exploring Attitudes and Overcoming Challenges in Implementing Differentiated Instruction in the Philippines' English Language Classrooms." Pp. 1–18 in *E3S Web of Conferences*. Vol. 425. EDP Sciences.

Hernandez, Froilan, and Kristopher Ngilangil. 2025. "Teaching English Under Matatag: A Closer Look at Grade 7 Teachers' Experiences." *Psychology and Education: A Multidisciplinary Journal* 45(2):166–84. doi:10.70838/pemj.450204.

Husnaini. 2025. "Navigating Challenges and Strategies in Implementing The Independent Curriculum: A Multi-Site Case Study of English Language Instruction in Junior and Senior High Schools in Palopo." *Linguistics Initiative* 5(1):178–90. doi:10.53696/27753719.51263.

Indraprasta, Syafitri Purnama, and Muhammad Ali Pawiro. 2023. "Implementation of the Independent Curriculum to Improve the Quality of Learning English." *Indonesian Journal of Educational Research and Review* 6(3):674–88. doi:10.23887/ijerr.v6i3.67645.

Jadoon, Atta Ur Rehman, Muhammad Ilyas Chishti, Muhammad Afzaal, and Tahir Afzal. 2020. "Challenges Faced by Newly Inducted Teachers Implementing Revised English Curriculum in Pakistan." *English Language Teaching* 13(7):52. doi:10.5539/elt.v13n7p52.

Jamero, Aileen A., and Mildred F. Accad. 2025. "Antecedents of Matatag Curriculum Implementation in Region XII: Creating a Model for Its Future Success." *International Journal of Science, Architecture, Technology and Environment* 2(5):542–51. doi:10.63680/xwerre455b675535.

Jelongos, Cielou S., and Nathaniel D. Naanep. 2025. "Extra Workload, Time Pressure and Teachers' Stress Levels." *International Journal of the Humanities and Social Sciences* 4(2):404–16. doi:doi.org/10.69651/PIJHSS040238.

Karakuş, Gülçin. 2021. " A Literary Review on Curriculum Implementation Problems." *Shanlax International Journal of Education s h a n l a x* 9(3):1–20. doi:10.34293/education.v9i3.3983.

Katshuna, Hilma M., and Elock E. Shikalepo. 2023. "Unpacking Teachers' Roles in the Implementation of New School Curriculum." *International Journal of Social Science and Human Research* 6(10):6430–33. doi:10.47191/ijsshr/v6-i10-83.

Kilag, Osias Kit, Glorybie C. Galve, Francisca T. Uy, and John Michael V. Sasan. 2024. "The New MATATAG Curriculum in the Lens of the 21st-Century 7Cs." *INTERNATIONAL MULTIDISCIPLINARY JOURNAL OF RESEARCH FOR INNOVATION, SUSTAINABILITY, AND EXCELLENCE (IMJRISE)* 1(5):418–25. doi:10.5281/zenodo.11392301.

Kilag, Osias Kit T., Glenn R. Andrin, Cynthia Abellanosa, Marlon T. Villaver Jr., Francisca T. Uy, and John Michael V. Sasan. 2024. "MATATAG Curriculum Rollout: Understanding Challenges for Effective Implementation." *INTERNATIONAL MULTIDISCIPLINARY JOURNAL OF RESEARCH FOR INNOVATION, SUSTAINABILITY, AND EXCELLENCE (IMJRISE)* 1(5). doi:10.5281/zenodo.11183037.

Kilag, Osias Kit T., Hubahib Jr. Santiago B., and John Michael V. Sasan. 2024. "Educational Transformation: The MATATAG Curriculum and Philippine Education Reform ." *INTERNATIONAL MULTIDISCIPLINARY JOURNAL OF RESEARCH FOR INNOVATION, SUSTAINABILITY, AND EXCELLENCE (IMJRISE)* 1(5). doi:10.5281/zenodo.11395449.

Kilag, Osias Kit T., John Michael V. Sasan, Guarin S. Maguate, Anielyn M. Abule, Myline A. Cornel, and Ronald A. Jayme. 2024. "A Comparative Study of K-12 and MATATAG Curricula." *INTERNATIONAL MULTIDISCIPLINARY JOURNAL OF RESEARCH FOR INNOVATION, SUSTAINABILITY, AND EXCELLENCE (IMJRISE)* 1(6):682–89. doi:10.5281/zenodo.11541760.

Lagbao, Jamaica Clarisse U. 2024. "INITIAL IMPLEMENTATION OF THE MATATAG CURRICULUM: VIEWS OF THE TEACHERS AND PRINCIPALS." *EPRA International Journal of Environmental Economics, Commerce and Educational Management* 11(7):10–17. doi:10.36713/epra17629.

Lahiya, Arkam, Opan Arifudin, and Tiara Fathulmila Matiala. 2025. "EDUCATION ADMINISTRATION REFORM: A CASE STUDY ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE MERDEKA CURRICULUM." *International Journal of Social and Education (INJOSEDU* 2(2):555–65. https://languar.net/index.php/INJOSEDU/article/view/131.

Lee Shing, Chien, Rohaida Mohd Saat, Siow Heng Loke, Institut Pendidikan Guru Kampus Tun Abdul Razak, and Sarawak chien. 2013. "The Knowledge of Teaching-Pedagogical Content Knowledge (PCK)." www.moj-es.net.

Lipom, Riena Jane C., Aimee P. Ramirez, Jomelvic A. Aresgado, and Natasha Nicole P. Barantes. 2025. "Development and Validation of Technology-Enriched Lesson in Fostering Reading Skills as Anchored in 'MATATAG' Curriculum." *INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF RESEARCH AND INNOVATION IN SOCIAL SCIENCE (IJRISS)* 9(3):1143–51. doi:10.47772/IJRISS.

Loza, Jaina F. 2024. *How Can Teachers Embrace Curriculum Change: Perceptions on the Implementation of MATATAG Curriculum*. doi:10.13140/RG.2.2.14271.52644.

Malbas, Marsha H., Osias Kit T. Kilag, Jr. ,. Felix, M. Diano, Benajamin D. Tiongzon, Aileen B. Catacutan, and Cara Frances K. Abendan. 2023. "In Retrospect and

Prospect: An Analysis of the Philippine Educational System and the Impact of K-12 Implementation." *International Multi-Disciplinary Journal of Education* 1(4):283–94. https://multijournals.org/index.php/excellencia-imje/article/view/65https://orcid.org/0000-0003-.

Malinao, Ana Joy, and John Joerry Miano. 2025. "Implementing the MATATAG Curriculum: A Qualitative Study on Teachers' Challenges, Adaptation Strategies, and Support Needs." *Journal of Interdisciplinary Perspectives* 3(5):362–74. doi:10.69569/jip.2025.133.

Maraveles, Jackielou, and Lutchie Ducot. 2025. "Challenges Encountered by Teachers in the Implementation of the MATATAG Curriculum." *Psychology and Education: A Multidisciplinary Journal* 40(5):723–32. doi:10.70838/PEMJ.400510.

Marinette, Bahtilla, and Xu Hui. 2020. "Instructional Leadership and Curriculum Implementation." *International Journal of Education and Research* 8:81–96. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/349640679_Instructional_Leadership_and_Curriculum_Implementation.

Marzo, Lailyn B., and Cecilia Q. Velasco. 2025. "Matatag Curriculum and Teacher's Performance." *International Journal of Research Publication and Reviews* 6(6):10491–504. https://ijrpr.com/uploads/V6ISSUE6/IJRPR49072.pdf.

Monton, Jenevie G., and Lutchie A. Ducot. 2025. "Teachers' Efficacy to Unpack Competencies in the MATATAG Curriculum." *Psychology and Education: A Multidisciplinary Journal* 40(1):27–48. doi:DOI:10.70838/pemj.400103.

Nengasca, Retse Jean R. 2025. "NAVIGATING THE TRANSITION BETWEEN K TO 12 AND MATATAG CURRICULUM: A GROUNDED THEORY STUDY OF SCHOOL LEADERS' DECISION-MAKING PROCESSES." *EPRA International Journal of Environmental Economics, Commerce and Educational Management* 12(5):205–11. doi:10.36713/epra21823.

Ngwenya, Victor C. 2020. "Curriculum Implementation Challenges Encountered by Primary School Teachers in Bulawayo Metropolitan Province, Zimbabwe." *Africa Education Review* 17(2):158–76. doi:10.1080/18146627.2018.1549953;PAGE:STRING:ARTICLE/CHAPTER.

Obja-an, John Roger A. 2024. "Junior High School Teachers' Curriculum Implementation Concerns in Reopening of Schools after COVID-19: The Philippine Context." *International Journal of Curriculum and Instruction* 16(2):333–49. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/379022878_Junior_high_school_teachers'_curriculum_implementation_concerns_in_reopening_of_schools_after_COVID-19_the_Philippine_context.

Omega, Manelyn G. 2025. "School Head's Instructional Supervisory Practices and Teachers' Performance in The Implementation of The Matatag Curriculum." *INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF ADVANCED MULTIDISCIPLINARY STUDIES* 5(7):731–45. https://www.ijams-bbp.net/wp-content/uploads/2025/07/7-IJAMS-JULY-2025-731-745.pdf.

Origenes, Rene Jr. S. 2025. "From the Most Essential Learning Competencies (MELC) to MATATAG Curriculum: A Call for Collaborative Piloting for Curriculum Innovation, Selection of English Competencies, and Module Design." *Elsevier in SSRN Electronic Journal* 1–16. doi:10.2139/ssrn.5159421.

Pak, Katie, Morgan S. Polikoff, Laura M. Desimone, and Erica Saldívar García. 2020. "The Adaptive Challenges of Curriculum Implementation: Insights for Educational Leaders Driving Standards-Based Reform." *AERA Open* 6(2):1–15. doi:10.1177/2332858420932828;PAGEGROUP:STRING:PUBLICATION.

Palestina, Randy L., Agripina D. Pangan, and Inero V. Ancho. 2020. "Curriculum Implementation Facilitating and Hindering Factors: The Philippines Context." *International Journal of Education* 13(2):91–102. doi:10.17509/ije.v13i2.25340.

Phillips, D. C. 2014. "Pedagogical Content Knowledge: Lee Shulman." *Encyclopedia of Educational Theory and Philosophy* 599–600. doi:10.4135/9781483346229.

Po, Enarcisa C. 2025. "Challenges Faced by School Heads and Teachers in the Implementation of the MATATAG Curriculum and Performance of Students." *INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF ADVANCED MULTIDISCIPLINARY STUDIES* 5(3):88–98. https://www.ijams-bbp.net/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/ENARCISA-C.-PO.pdf.

Saro, Jeffry Morilla, Crisanta B. Montejo, Jessielyn A. Sucong, Maria Fe O. Bustamante, and Junahlyn B. Perez. 2024. "A Qualitative Exploration on the Perceived Impact of the MATATAG Curriculum on Basic Education Teaching in the School Year 2024-2025." *International Journal of Advanced Multidisciplinary Research and Stduies* 4(4):952–66. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/383272918_A_Qualitative_Exploration_on_the_Perceived_Impact_of_the_MATATAG_Curriculum_on_Basic_Education_Teaching_in_the_School_Year_2024-2025.

Takyi, Benjamin, Clarke Ebow Yalley, Frederick Owusu, and Portia Acquah Fynn. 2025. "Challenges Towards the Implementation of the Standards-Based Curriculum in Ghana: A Systematic Review." *International Journal of Instruction* 18(3):577–94. doi:10.29333/iji.2025.18330a.

Toledo, Welfe A. 2025. "Resource Management Strategies of School Head in Supporting MATATAG Curriculum and Performance of Teachers and Learners." *INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF ADVANCED MULTIDISCIPLINARY STUDIES* 5(3):2799–0664. https://www.ijams-bbp.net/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/WELFE-A.-TOLEDO.pdf.

Torrefiel, Josephine C., Estelita S. Cagape, Onabelle V. Galan, Venice P. Doydora, and Tejie D. Pintac. 2025. "Teachers' Lived Experiences in the Transition to the MATATAG Curriculum: A Phenomenological Inquiry into Adaptation, Challenges, and Growth." *Journal of Interdisciplinary Perspectives* 3(4):344–50. doi:10.69569/jip.2025.041.

Tumala, Re-Ann M. 2024. "TEACHER'S EXPERIENCE ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF SPIRAL PROGRESSION APPROACH (SPA) IN TEACHING ENGLISH TO JUNIOR HIGH SCHOOL: A QUALITATIVE INQUIRY." *Cognizance Journal of*

Multidisciplinary Studies 4(6):98–208. doi:10.47760/cognizance.2024.v04i06.010.

Uy, Francisca T., Osias Kit T. Kilag, Julanie L. Abella, John Michael V. Sasan, Rio M. Emping, and Debie N. Cabuyao. 2024. "Filipino Learners: Exploring the New MATATAG Curriculum for Literacy and Numeracy." *INTERNATIONAL MULTIDISCIPLINARY JOURNAL OF RESEARCH FOR INNOVATION, SUSTAINABILITY, AND EXCELLENCE (IMJRISE)* 1(6):888–95. doi:10.5281/zenodo.11669202.

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: JOECYL T. MONTALBAN
ADDRESS: P-4, Burgos St. Poblacion 3 Buenavista
Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: joecyl_montalban@smccnasipit.edu.ph
Personal Information



Sex: Female
Date of birth: July 06, 2005
Height: 4’8
Weight: 47
Civil Status: Single



Educational Attainment

Elementary: Buenavista Central Elementary School
Secondary: Buenavista Special Education High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: RUCMINIE U. GESTA
ADDRESS: Punta, Nasipit Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: rucminie_gesta@smccnasipit.edu.ph
Personal Information

Sex: Female

Date of biryh: April 28, 2004
Height: 5'0
Weight: 47
Civil Status: Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary: Mount Olive School of the Philippines
Secondary: Paknaan National Highschool
Tertiary : University of Cebu Lapu-Lapu Mandaue

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: MARIA FE L. BERMAS
ADDRESS: P-1, Poblacion Talo-ao, Buenavista Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: mariafe_bermas@smccnasipit.edu.ph
Personal Information

Sex: Female



Date of birth: May 16, 2005
Height: 4'5
Weight: 40
Civil Status: Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Olave Buenavista National High School
Secondary : Simbalan National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: RALPH C. BERTUMEN
ADDRESS: P-8 Tinago Brgy. Matabao Buenavista Agusan Del Norte
EMAIL: ralph_bertumen@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex: Male



Date of birth: July 17, 2003
Height: 5'5
Weight: 56
Civil Status: Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary: Tinago Elementary School
Secondary: Saint James High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

APPENDICES

CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTIC AUTHORSHIP